

brings a different value to the table. We will see more standardisation across some of the underlying fundamental blocks to ensure compatibility. For instance, Linux started as an open source project while Microsoft Windows was totally closed source; yet, they still have a number of partnerships.”

Data privacy

There are already a lot of copyright and patent infringement cases around data privacy as many open source projects are being used without the consent of the original creator. Although we have better control over such scenarios in the real world, this is not the case in the Metaverse as the person is not physically present there. It is not clear yet if the virtual property in the Metaverse will have any analogy in the physical world.

“When it comes to hardware, technology has evolved exponentially in terms of security, power and

features. Every smart device today is connected to a network, which is also exposing it to various security threats. So semiconductor companies, too, are focusing on resolving these security threats,” says Khasim.

There could be trademark issues too. Biju Nair says, “Let us say you have a trademark in the physical world but have no presence in the virtual world. Then the chances of you getting an injunction for trademark misuse are very low. Such a case has already been brought before a US court — E.S.S. Entertainment versus Rock Star Videos. The court ruled that the depiction of a physical world trademark in any video game does not infringe on the original trademark, as the video game is an artistic expression protected by the First Amendment. So you may not be protected in the Metaverse unless you have some sort of presence there.”

Nair adds, “Companies need to revisit their existing agreements, see

what rights have been provided to them, and plan accordingly. They also need to check if they have filed for the trademark for virtual goods or not, because if they don’t do that they will be at risk of losing the rights for those goods in the Metaverse workspace.”

There are a lot of legalities that need to be looked at and addressed separately in the Metaverse. Nonetheless, the way forward is exciting and interesting as there is still a lot to be explored and developed in this new virtual world. **END** 🐼

This article is put together from a panel discussion at ‘Open Source Summit: Frontiers of Innovation 2022’, an event co-hosted by Samsung and IEEE Bangalore.

*Transcribed and curated by
Laveesh Kocher*

www.opensourceforu.com

EPYGROUP

Open Source Is **Hot** In The IT World

Technologies shown as steam: Hadoop, Apache, PostgreSQL, Android, MySQL, OSS, PEARL, OpenStack, Joomla, Drupal, PHP.

THE COMPLETE MAGAZINE ON OPEN SOURCE



- >> To find dealers to buy copy from news-stand, visit: www.ezine.lfyimag.com
- >> To subscribe, visit: pay.efyindia.com
- >> To buy an ezine edition, visit: www.magzter.com choose Open Source For You